Bodo Literature, Authors & Poetic Anthology

Historical Periods, Literary Pioneers, and Multilingual Poetic Specimens

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1. Chronological Epochs of Bodo Literature

• Pre-Bibar Era (Before 1920): Oral epics, Bathou devotional chants, folk ballads and early missionary translations.

• Bibar Era (1920-1935): Renaissance of written Bodo literature sparked by Gurudev Kalicharan Brahma, Bibar journal (1924), and student congresses.

• Post-Independence & Sabha Era (1952-1980): Establishment of Bodo Sahitya Sabha (1952), script movement, school textbooks, and social realism in poetry.

• Contemporary & Eighth Schedule Era (1980-Present): Recognition under Eighth Schedule (2003), Sahitya Akademi awards, modern novels, and literary critique.

2. Eminent Authors & Pioneers

Name	Lifespan	Literary Contribution
Gurudev Kalicharan Brahma	1860–1938	Social reformer, philosopher, pioneer of Bodo social renaissance and Brahma Dharma movement.
Satish Chandra Basumatary	1901–1974	Chief editor of 'Bibar' (1924), dramatist, songwriter, pioneer of modern Bodo drama.
Modaram Brahma	1903–1973	Eminent poet, dramatist, educationist; composer of prayers, Padma Shri recipient.
Rupnath Brahma	1902–1968	Statesman, poet, dramatist; author of early mystic songs and religious texts.
Kamal Kumar Brahma	1929–2006	Distinguished dramatist, folklorist, pioneer of modern Bodo theatre.
Bihuram Boro	1932–2000	Poet, linguist, author of critical treatises on Bodo syntax and prosody.
Dharanidhar Wary	1923–2008	Folklorist, collector of Bodo folktales, Sahitya Akademi awardee.
Nilkamal Brahma	1944–1998	Renowned short story writer, master of Bodo prose and social portrayal.

3. Poetic Masterpieces & Verse Specimens

बैसागुनि बार — The Breeze of Spring (Bwisagu)

Poet: Modaram Brahma | Epoch: Bibar Era | Theme: Nature renewal, New Year joyous awakening, pastoral bliss.

Devanagari Original:

बैसागुनि बार बाबाय, गोदान बोथोर फैबाय,
दैसा-दैयाव दै बुंफबबाय, बबिार बारबाय दैमा सेराव।
गोबां सानन्नि उनाव बोथोर सलियबाय,
मानसफिोरन्नि गोसोआव रंजानाय बुंफबबाय।

Roman Transcription:

Bwisagu ni bar babay, gwdan bwthwr fwibay,

Dwisao-dwyao dwi bungfwbbay, bibar barbay dwima serao.

Gwbaw sanni unao bwthwr silaybay,

Mansiphorni goswao rwangjanay bungfwbbay.

English Translation:

The gentle breeze of spring has whispered; the new year has dawned,

Streams swell with fresh mountain water; blossoms unveil along the riverbank.

After long weary days the winter season departs,

And radiant joy fills every beating human heart.

आं बर' — I am a Bodo

Poet: Satish Chandra Basumatary | Epoch: Renaissance Period | Theme: Indigenous identity, dignity, devotion to ancestral roots.

Devanagari Original:

आं बर', आं बर' हारनि फिसा,
हाग्रामायाव आंन्नि जोनोम, दैमायाव आंन्नि गोजां जउि।
गबि बैसोनफि्राय आं गावन्नि हारखौ मोजां मोनो,
बाथौन्नि सजिौ गांसेयाव आंन्नि जउिन्नि समिां।

Roman Transcription:

Ang Boro, ang Boro harini fisa,

Hagramayao angni jwnwm, dwimayao angni gwojang jiu.

Gibi bwisonifray ang gawni harikhwo mwjang mwnw,

Bathouni Sijou gangseyao angni jiuni simang.

English Translation:

I am Bodo, son of an ancient lineage,

Born of the deep wild woodlands, nurtured by crystalline streams.

From early infancy I hold my community dear to my soul,

In the sacred five ribs of the Sijou tree resides my life's vision.

मैनाव दावबायनाय — The Golden Flight of Mainao

Poet: Traditional Folk Bard | Epoch: Traditional Liturgical | Theme: Devotional adoration of agricultural providence.

Devanagari Original:

मैनाव बुरै फैबाय दैमा बासनिानै,
माइबाख्रयिाव बाहागो होफैबाय रंजानानै।
दंफांनि गांसे बलिाइयावबो दावसि मोसादों,
आथखिालनि संसारआव बर'नि मैनाव गोजोन होफैबाय।

Roman Transcription:

Mainao burwi fwibay dwima basinanwi,

Maibakhriyao bahagw hwfwibay rwangjananwi.

Dongfangni gangse bilaiyaobo daosi mosadwng,

Athikhalni swnsarao Bworoni Mainao gwojwn hwfwibay.

English Translation:

Mother Mainao descends across gentle flowing waters,

Filling empty granaries with golden abundance and mirth.

Upon every woodland leaf the birds flutter in graceful dance,

Granting tranquility and blessing to the Bodo hearth.